The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of Maitreya"

Āryamaitripratijñānāmadhāraṇī · Toh 890 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་བརྒྱས་པས་དམ་བཅས་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of Maitreya," known in Sanskrit as Ārya Maitrī Pratijñā Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Jampé Dam Chepa Zhejawé Zung, is a short incantatory text devoted to Maitreya, the bodhisattva who is destined to become the next buddha of our world. After paying homage to the Three Jewels and to Maitreya, it presents a sequence of three mantras, a root secret mantra, a heart mantra, and a near-heart mantra, which invoke the Buddha Śākyamuni and call upon Maitreya under epithets such as the Invincible One. The text then gives Maitreya's own vow: when he attains full awakening, he will benefit anyone who has merely heard, read, recited, kept in mind, or meditated on this dhāraṇī. It is Toh 890 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of protective and devotional spells gathered within the Buddhist canon.

In the language of India: ārya maitri pratijñā nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of Maitreya."

Homage to the Three Jewels!
Homage to the Victor Maitreya!

namo ratna trayāya oṃ namo bhagavate śākya munaye tathāgatāya arhate samyaksaṃ buddhāya tadyathā oṃ ajite ajite aparājite ajitanjaya hara hara maitri avalokite kara kara mahā samaya siddhe bhara bhara mahā bodhi maṇḍa bīje smara smara āsmakaṃ samaya bodhi bodhi mahā bodhi svāhā

This is the root secret mantra.

oṃ mohi mohi mahā mohi svāhā

This is the heart mantra.

oṃ muni muni smara svāhā

This is the near-heart mantra.

As for anyone who merely hears this dhāraṇī, or reads it, recites it, brings it properly to mind, or simply meditates on it: when I have become fully and manifestly awakened in unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, I will certainly seek out that being, and I will prophesy their unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Even if one proclaims it into the ears of wild animals and birds, born in the animal realm, they too will obtain the prophecy of unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Merely by hearing this, one will never go to the lower realms. One will not be stained by the defilements of the lower realms. Nor will one be born from a mother's womb. For a thousand divine eons one will be a universal monarch. One will possess the ten paths of virtuous action. Whatever wealth one wishes for and seeks will be obtained.

Blessed One, I will not forget that being. Having certainly gone to the seat of awakening, however that being may have turned out, I will prophesy their unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

This completes the Noble Dhāraṇī Called "The Vow of Maitreya."

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Vajrapāṇi and the Tibetan translator, the monk Chökyi Sherab.

Translator's Notes

• Maitreya speaks the vow and addresses the Blessed One, as the title indicates. The verb rendered "forget" can also mean "neglect." Either way, the promise is that Maitreya will not leave such a being unattended.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.